NC STATE UNIVERSITY

Office Space Kit-of-Parts

A Guide for Planning, Furnishing, and Managing University Office Spaces

Last Updated: October 2025



The Office Space Kit-of-Parts provides guidance for planning, furnishing, and managing the spaces provided within a unit's Office Space Budget. The intent of these guidelines is to provide each unit the choice, variety, and flexibility to allocate their Office Space Budget to meet their own unique needs. Modular, standardized building blocks ensure spaces not only meet today's needs but can also adapt to future needs.

The guidelines provided in the following pages are not intended to be rigid but instead to serve as a flexible framework for the unique conditions across campus. New construction projects, renovation work, and reallocation of existing space will each require a nuanced approach. Room layouts and furniture configurations are included as examples and are not intended to represent the full range of options available within each space type.

The following resources provide additional guidance:

- **Headcount and Flexible Work Arrangement**
  Form to provide information on a unit's current headcount and flexible work, including current positions, funded vacant positions, projected 5-year growth, and student workers. Upon receiving this information, Campus Planning and Strategic Investment will assign an Office Space Budget as outlined in the Office Space Standards.

- **Space Planning Tool**
  Calculator to explore possible combinations of the Office Space Kit-of-Parts within an allocated Office Space Budget. This spreadsheet is not intended to serve as the final program but instead supports exploration of the types of spaces that could be included within a unit's Office Space Budget.

This guiding framework is intended to support a collaborative planning process, providing a baseline for design of effective workspaces, flexible planning for long-term use, and responsible stewardship of campus resources.

Maximizing An Office Space Budget

As units determine the best mix of space for their needs, several strategies can maximize an Office Space Budget:

Right-size spaces

- The Office Space Kit-of-Parts offers a range of workpoint sizes. Considering smaller footprints for individual workpoints allows an Office Space Budget to go further.

Provide access to a variety of space types

- The Office Space Kit-of-Parts offers a variety of open and enclosed spaces. Balancing individually assigned hard-walled spaces with open and shared spaces promotes efficient use of space and allows for future flexibility.
- Employing an activity-based work strategy allows each person access to a variety of spaces that support different activities rather than assigning individual spaces based on titles.
- A combination of open workpoints + available private spaces can serve to optimize space utilization while also meeting privacy needs.

Store only what is needed

- Minimizing on-site storage is consistent with NC State's Space Principles and allows space for people to be prioritized over space for things.

Prioritize sharing

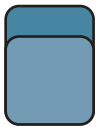
- While the Office Space Kit-of-Parts allows for workpoints to be either individually assigned, assigned as shared, or unassigned, space types such as flex offices and shared offices provide models for effective sharing.
- In addition to workpoints, focus spaces, collaborative spaces, and support spaces can also be shared among employees, teams, and units.
- Sharing ensures spaces are used as many hours per week as possible, optimizing university resources and promoting vibrant, well-utilized buildings.

Building Blocks



30 sf
5x6

Benching



36 sf, 48 sf
6x6, 6x8

Workstation



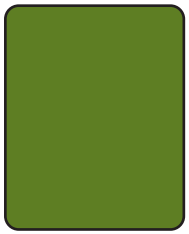
60 sf
6x10

Focus Room
Kitchenette*
Copy / Print*
Storage*



100 sf
10x10

Office
Flex Office
Shared Office
Huddle Room
Open Collaboration*



180 sf
12x15

Small Conference

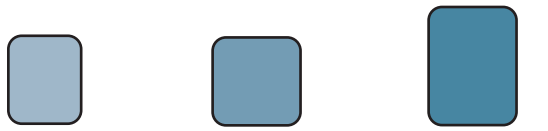
	Square Footage (SF)	Dimensions (FT)
WORK POINTS		
Benching	30	5x6
Workstation	36, 48	6x6, 6x8
Office / Flex Office / Shared Office	100	10x10
FOCUS SPACES		
Focus Room[1]	60	6x10
COLLABORATIVE SPACES		
Open Collaboration*	100	10x10
Huddle Room (2-4 people)	100	10x10
Small Conference (5-6 people)	180	12x15
SUPPORT SPACES		
Kitchenette*	60	6x10
Copy / Print*	60	6x10
Storage *	60	6x10

[1] Free-standing furniture options (phone booths) may also be utilized for focus space. Footprints for these solutions range from approximately 16 SF / 4x4 (single occupant) to 32 SF / 8x4 (two person).
* Planning module; for example, a kitchenette may be one module for a small unit (60 sf) or two (120 sf) to three (180 sf) modules for larger units.

Work Points

BENCHING
WORKSTATION

Benching and **Workstations** are furniture options for individual workpoints within an open office space. These stations can be provided in a variety of configurations, ranging from more private to more open, and can be equipped with sit/stand desks, dual monitors, and a range of storage options.



30 sf
5x6
Benching

36 sf
6x6
Workstation

48 sf
6x8
Workstation

Open office workpoints maximize flexibility, as furniture systems can be more easily reconfigured than hard walled spaces.

More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Group touchdowns and workstations to reflect functional adjacencies and to create neighborhoods within open office space	Touchdowns and workstations can be assigned to an individual, assigned as shared (among specific employees or a specific team), or unassigned
Locate open office space at the perimeter of the building, adjacent to windows, to ensure access to daylight and views by the majority of occupants	Establish cleaning protocols / etiquette for shared or unassigned workpoints
Specify partition heights that provide seated privacy while preserving access to day-light by the majority of occupants	Provide a monitor and docking station at all shared or unassigned workpoints. Provide storage for personal keyboards, headsets, and mice
Separate workpoints from main entries, collaborative spaces, and kitchenettes to create quieter work zones	Coordinate phone setup with Communication Technologies to utilize Extension Mobility at all shared or unassigned workpoints
Utilize file storage, acoustic panels, phone booths, or other elements to zone open office areas, limit noise transmission, and avoid a sea of cubicles	Provide an easy-to-use booking system such as Google calendar for shared or unassigned workpoints
In larger open office areas, consider providing a sound masking system meeting LEED standards for minimum and maximum dBA levels	Provide technology that supports individual focused work, such as noise-cancelling headphones and task lighting

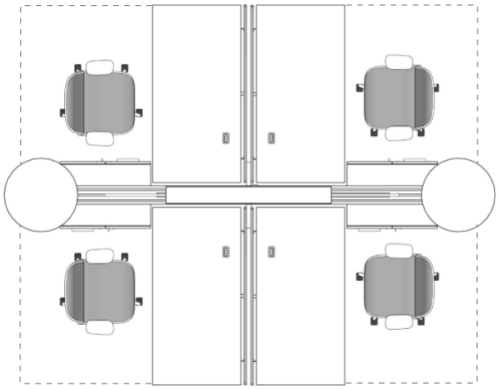
Work Points

BENCHING

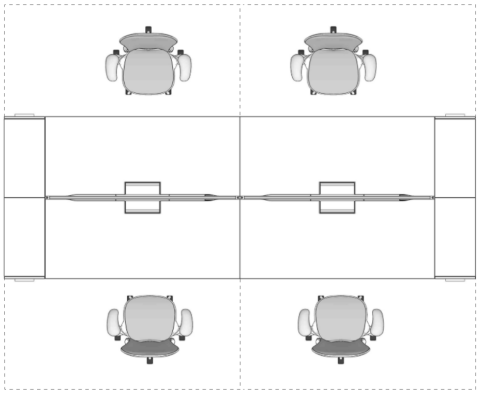
Example diagrams below show four stations.

30 sf
5x6

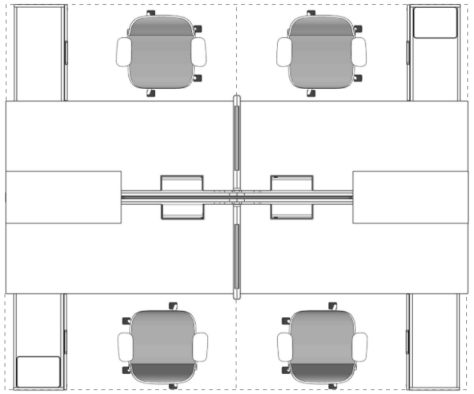
Benching



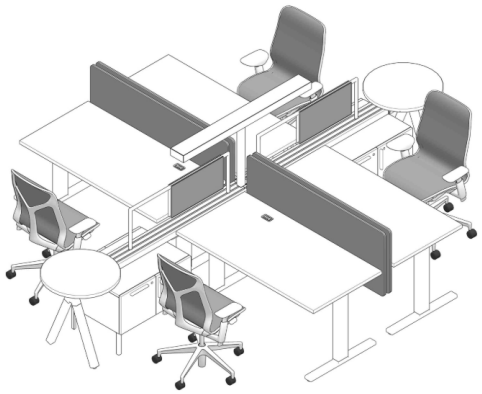
EXAMPLE 1

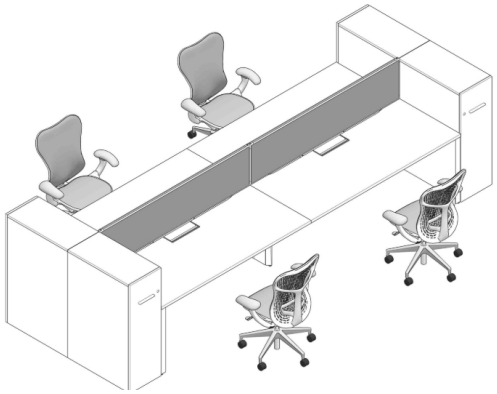


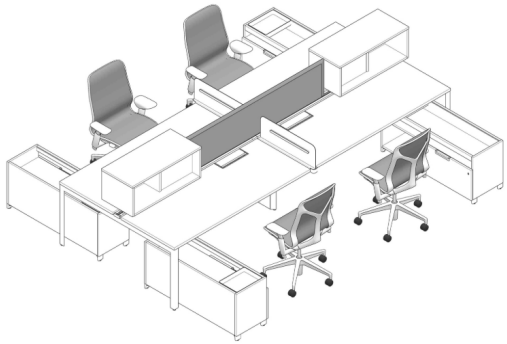
EXAMPLE 2



EXAMPLE 3







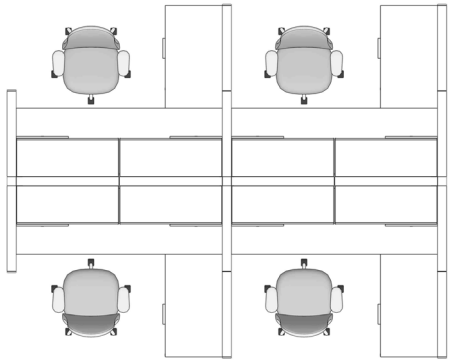
Work Points

6X6 WORKSTATION

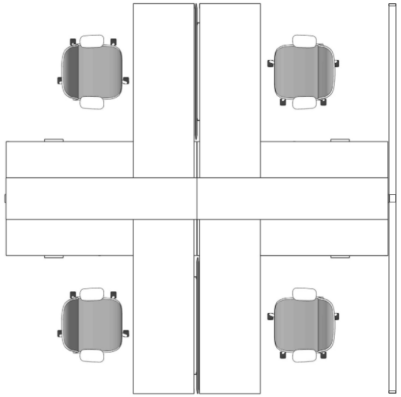
Example diagrams below show four stations.

36 sf
6x6

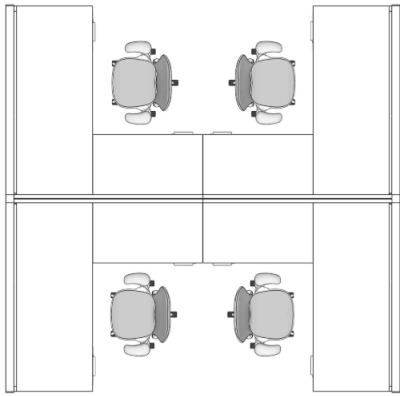
Workstation



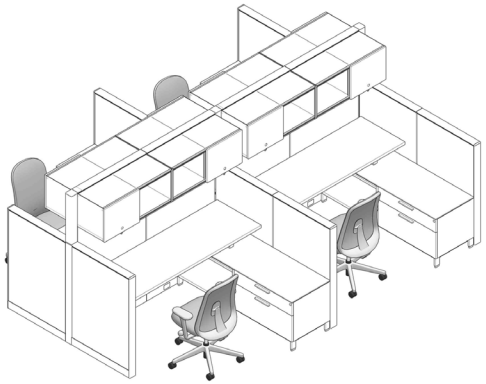
EXAMPLE 1



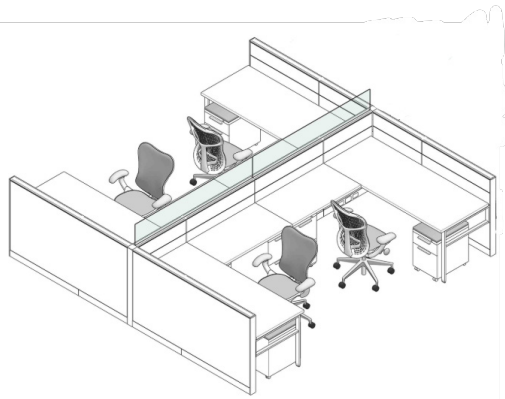
EXAMPLE 2



EXAMPLE 3







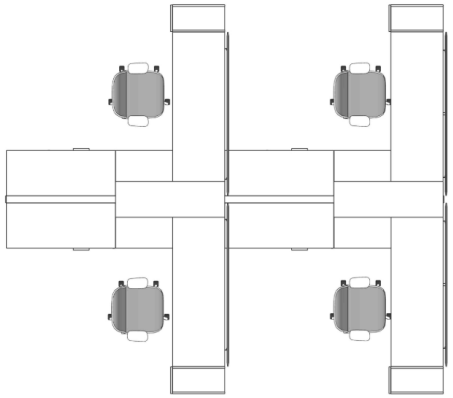
Work Points

6X8 WORKSTATION

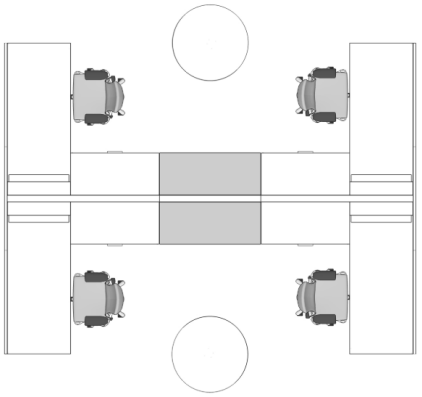
Example diagrams below show four stations.

48 sf
6x8

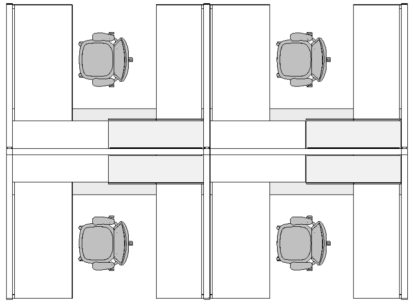
Workstation



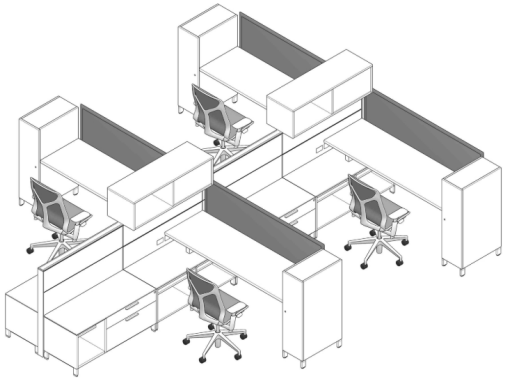
EXAMPLE 1



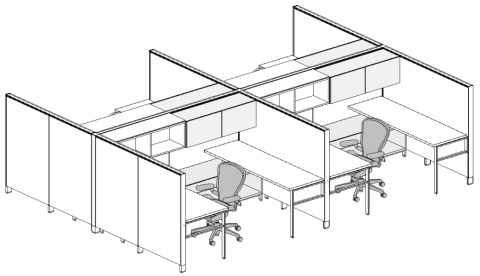
EXAMPLE 2



EXAMPLE 3







Source: Workstation diagrams referenced from HermanMiller website (Planning Ideas)

Work Points

OFFICE, FLEX OFFICE, SHARED OFFICE

Offices are enclosed individual workpoints. These rooms provide acoustically isolated space for activities such as video conferencing, private conversations, and heads down work. Full-time faculty are to be provided with dedicated, individually assigned offices. Emeriti faculty may share office space, based on availability. Employees are limited to one office and are to utilize touchdown space when working elsewhere on campus.

Flex Offices are enclosed individual workpoints that can be used by others when the employee assigned to them is not actively using the space. Furniture and technology can be provided in a variety of configurations to support multipurpose use, such as a desk for individual work and a small table and chairs for video conferencing or one-on-one meetings.

Shared Offices are enclosed shared workpoints. Furniture and technology can be provided in a variety of configurations to support shared use, such as two desks for individual work.



100 sf
10x10

Office
Flex Office
Shared Office

Flex offices and shared offices maximize the utilization of office space by allowing these spaces to be occupied throughout the day and week.

More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Construction to follow best practices for acoustic privacy	Offices and shared offices can be assigned to individuals, assigned as shared (among specific employees or a specific team), or unassigned. Assigned offices can be designated as flex offices so that they are available for use by others when the employee assigned to them is not actively using the space
In open office plans, locate offices at the interior of the building so they are not blocking access to daylight	Establish cleaning protocols / etiquette for shared, flex or unassigned offices
Provide interior glazing for transparency and access to borrowed daylight. Window film can be utilized to provide privacy while also allowing for light transmission	Provide a monitor and docking station at all shared, flex, or unassigned offices. Provide storage for personal keyboards, headsets, and mice
Provide furniture that is appropriately scaled to the space and reconfigurable as needed	Coordinate phone setup with Communication Technologies to utilize Extension Mobility at all shared or unassigned offices
Provide lockable personal storage (such as a pedestal or locker) for all employees, whether in assigned, shared assigned, or unassigned space	For flex or unassigned offices, provide a digital schedule outside the room to communicate when the office is available (either unscheduled or available for flex use by others)
	Provide an easy-to-use booking system such as Google calendar for flex or unassigned offices

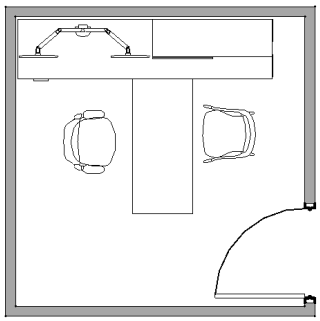
Work Points

OFFICE, FLEX OFFICE, SHARED OFFICE

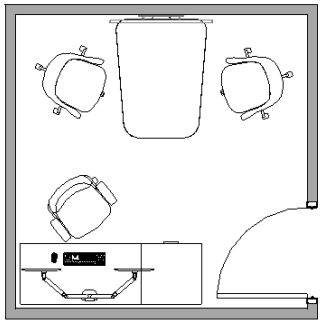
Example diagrams below show office, flex office and shared office options.

100 sf
10x10

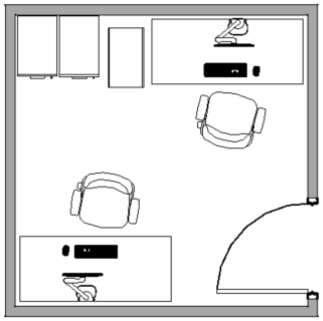
Office
Flex Office
Shared Office

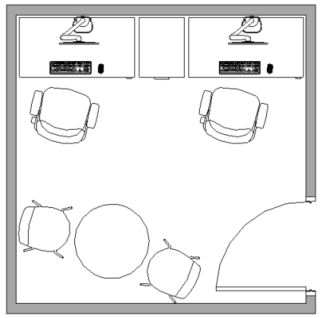


OFFICE EXAMPLE

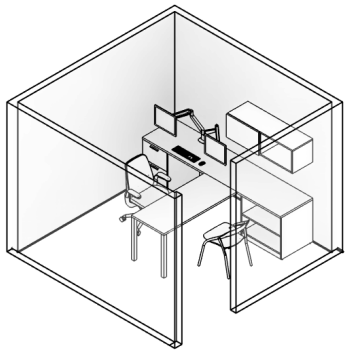


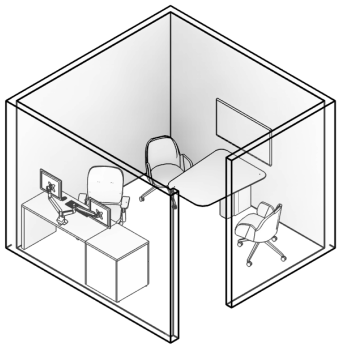
FLEX OFFICE EXAMPLE

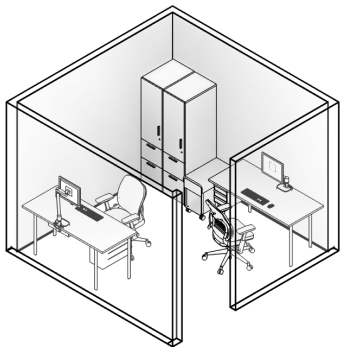




SHARED OFFICE EXAMPLES









Focus Spaces

FOCUS ROOM

Focus Rooms are enclosed spaces for one to two people. These rooms provide acoustically isolated space for activities such as video conferencing, private conversations, or heads down work. Furniture and technology can be provided in a variety of configurations to support specific uses, such as a monitor, docking station, desk, and task chair to support individual use for focused work or video conferencing.



60 sf
6x10

Focus Room

Pairing focus rooms + open office workpoints maximizes flexibility and efficient use of space by providing access to private work space on an as-needed basis.

More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Construction to follow best practices for acoustic privacy	Provide an easy-to-use booking system such as Google calendar. Limit booking duration to a two-hour maximum block of time
Provide interior glazing for transparency and access to borrowed daylight. Window film can be utilized to provide privacy while also allowing for light transmission	Provide digital schedule outside the room to display current and upcoming bookings

Focus Spaces

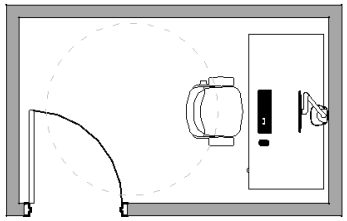
FOCUS ROOM

Example diagrams below.

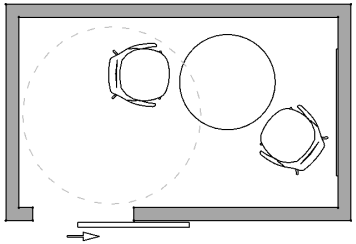


60 sf
6x10

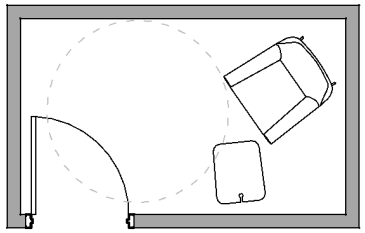
Focus Room



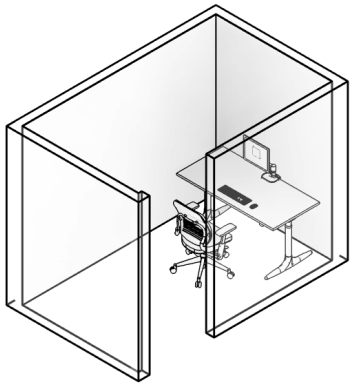
EXAMPLE 1

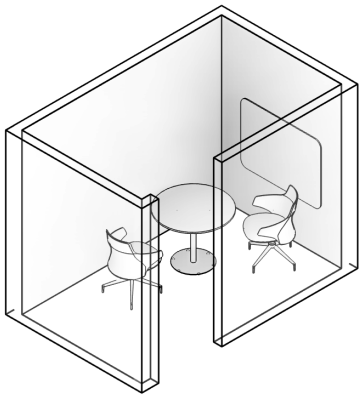


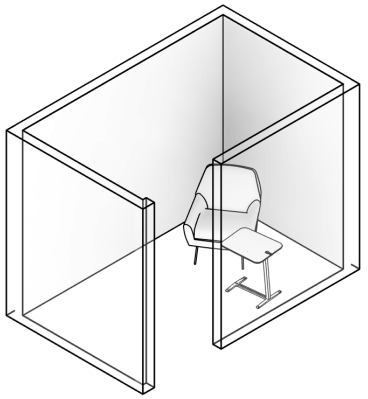
EXAMPLE 2



EXAMPLE 3





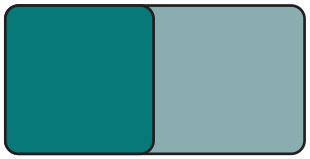


Collaborative Spaces

OPEN COLLABORATION

Open Collaboration areas use furniture to create collaborative spaces within an open office space. These areas may be assigned to an individual unit or shared by several units within the same suite. Furniture and technology can be provided in a variety of configurations to support a range of uses, such as seating for lunch / breaks, drop-in work space, pre-meeting waiting space, informal team meeting space, or touchdown space for student workers.

The planning unit for open collaboration areas is to be considered as a module and can be scaled to the number of employees and proposed use.



100 sf 10x10 **200 sf** 10x20

Open Collaboration

Open collaboration areas maximize flexibility by supporting a wide variety of uses and allowing for easy reconfiguration.

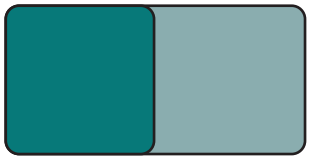
More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Locate near entries, meeting spaces, and/or kitchenettes to allow for flexible, multi-purpose use	Tools that foster collaboration (such as digital displays for screen sharing or freestanding markerboards) may be provided
Consider the intended use of the open collaboration area in order to avoid conflicts between loud and quiet spaces In some instances, open collaboration areas may be located near or within workstations to support collaborative teams. In other instances, open collaboration areas may need to be separated from quiet, heads-down workspace	
Use acoustic panels, carpet, and other sound-absorbing materials to minimize noise transmission	
Provide comfortable furniture that supports a variety of uses and is easily reconfigurable	
Provide receptacles for charging devices	
Locate adjacent to windows when possible to provide access to daylight and views	

Collaborative Spaces

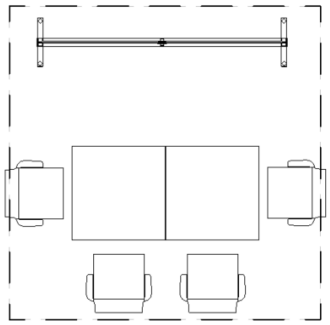
OPEN COLLABORATION

Example diagrams below.

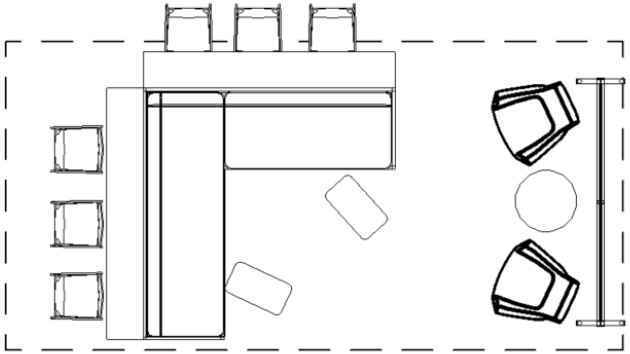


100 sf 10x10 **200 sf** 10x20

Open Collaboration

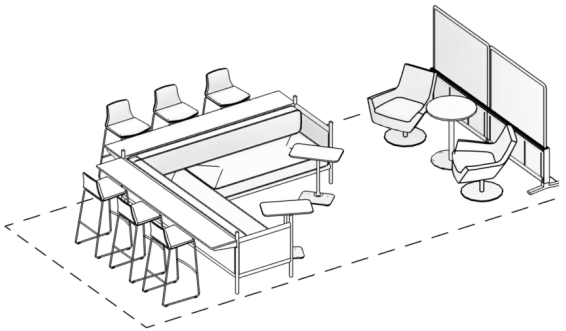


100 SF EXAMPLE



200 SF EXAMPLE





Collaborative Spaces

HUDDLE ROOM

Huddle Rooms are enclosed collaborative meeting spaces for up to four people. These rooms provide acoustically isolated space for activities such as video conferencing, team meetings, or private conversations.



100 sf
10x10

Huddle Room

Huddle rooms relieve the pressure on conference rooms by providing space for video conferencing or small meetings. These spaces can easily convert to offices, maximizing flexibility and allowing for future growth.

More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Construction to follow best practices for acoustic privacy	Provide an easy-to-use booking system such as Google calendar
Provide interior glazing for transparency and access to borrowed daylight. Window film can be utilized to provide privacy while also allowing for light transmission	Provide digital schedule outside the room to display current and upcoming meetings
Huddle rooms are to be laid out and planned so that they are interchangeable with offices to allow for future flexibility	Equip the room with plug-and-play technology that supports video conferencing

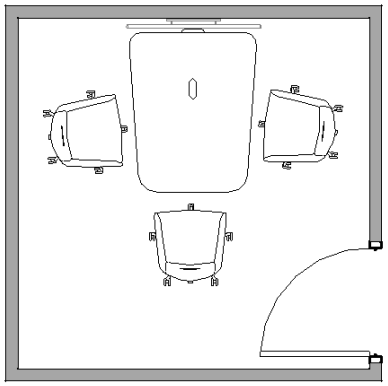
Collaborative Spaces

HUDDLE ROOM

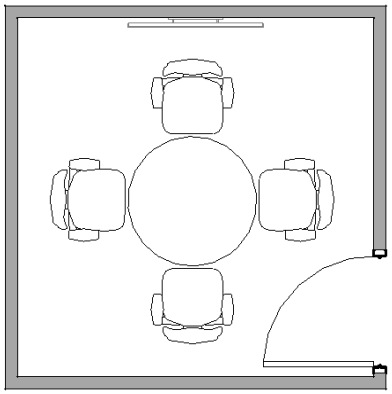
Example diagrams below.

100 sf
10x10

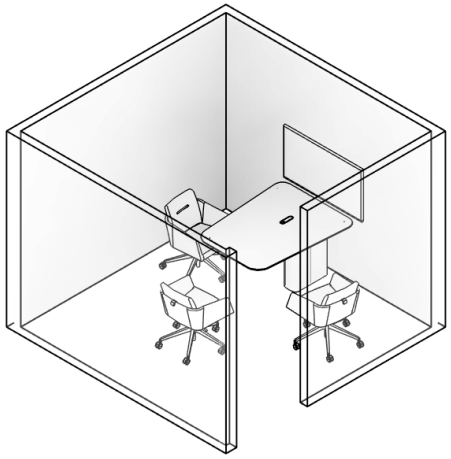
Huddle Room

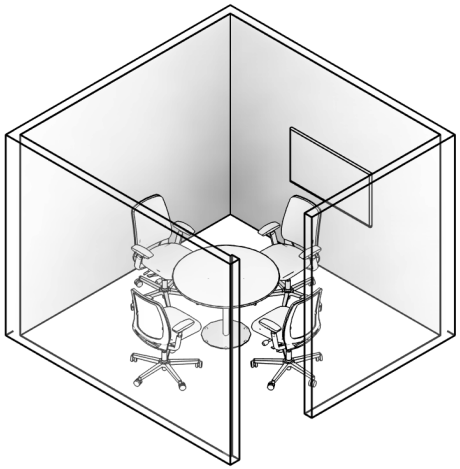


EXAMPLE 1



EXAMPLE 2





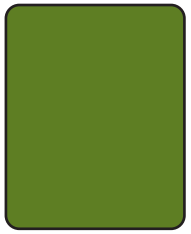
Collaborative Spaces

SMALL CONFERENCE

Small Conference rooms are enclosed collaborative meeting spaces for five to six people. These spaces are located within an office suite and may be assigned to an individual unit or shared by several units within the same suite. These rooms provide acoustically isolated space for in-person or hybrid meetings.

Small conference rooms relieve the pressure on medium and large conference rooms by providing space for frequently occurring meetings.

More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2



180 sf
12x15

Small Conference

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Construction to follow best practices for acoustic privacy	Provide an easy-to-use booking system such as Google calendar, with room data provided for reference
Provide receptacles at conference table(s) for charging devices	Provide digital schedule outside the room to display current and upcoming meetings
Provide window coverings or translucent privacy film at interior glazing. Provide window coverings to minimize glare at exterior glazing	Equip the room with plug-and-play technology that supports video conferencing
Furnish with table(s) and chairs that are easy to reconfigure	

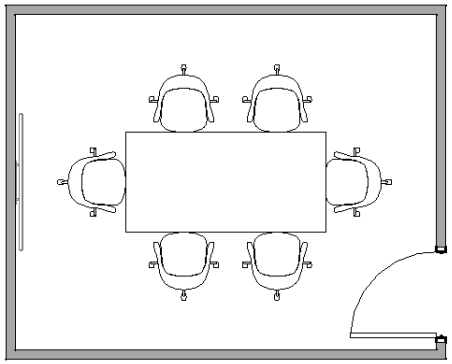
Collaborative Spaces

SMALL CONFERENCE

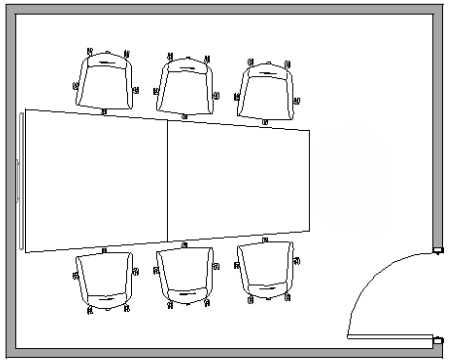
Example diagrams below.

180 sf
12x15

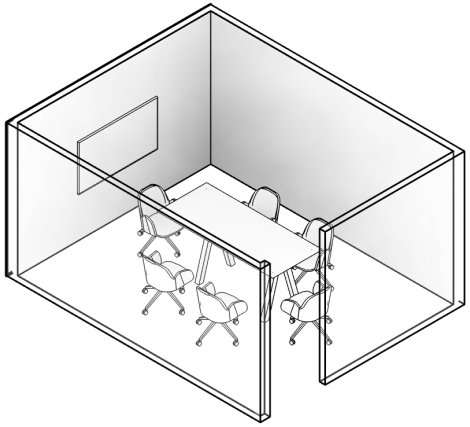
Small Conference

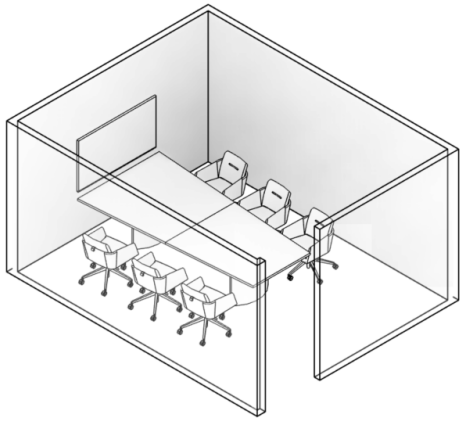


EXAMPLE 1



EXAMPLE 2



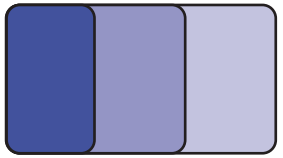


Support Spaces

KITCHENETTE

Kitchenettes are food storage and preparation areas located within an office suite. These spaces may be assigned to an individual unit or shared by several units within the same suite. The primary function of a kitchenette is to provide space for employees to store and prepare food and drink. Seating may be provided in other locations (such as Open Collaboration or Flexible Gathering Spaces), and vending is to be located on common corridors, outside of individual office suites.

The planning unit for a kitchenette is to be considered as a module and can be scaled to the number of employees.



60 sf 6x10 **120 sf** 12x10 **180 sf** 18x10

Kitchenette

Pairing kitchenettes + open collaboration areas maximizes flexibility and efficient use of space by allowing seating areas to be used throughout the day instead of only at lunchtime.

More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Locate adjacent to Open Collaboration or Flexible Gathering Spaces with tables and chairs for seating	Establish cleaning protocols / etiquette for refrigerators and other shared appliances
Provide acoustic separation from workpoints and other quiet spaces	Ensure all employees have access to space to store and prepare food and drink
Prioritize counter space and adequate space for appliances, with a limited number of storage cabinets	
Provide a sink and power for microwave(s), coffee maker(s), and refrigerator(s)	
Allocate space for trash, recycling and compost units as provided by NC State Waste Reduction and Recycling either within the kitchenette or in an adjacent area	
Specify durable finishes that can be easily cleaned such as plastic laminate cabinets, solid surface/quartz countertops, and tile backsplashes	

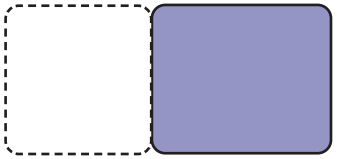
Support Spaces

KITCHENETTE

Example diagrams below.



60 sf
6x10
Kitchenette

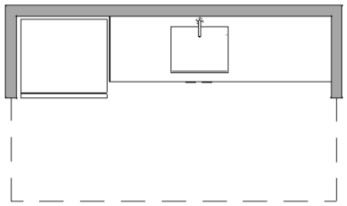


100 sf
10x10
Open Collaboration

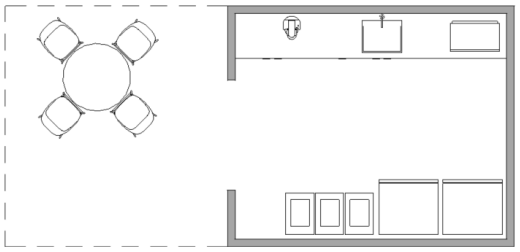
120 sf
12x10
Kitchenette



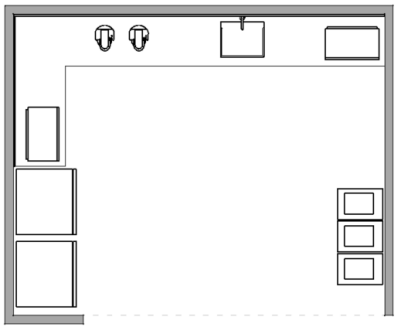
180 sf
Kitchenette



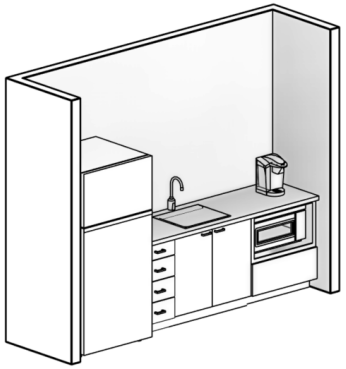
60 SF EXAMPLE

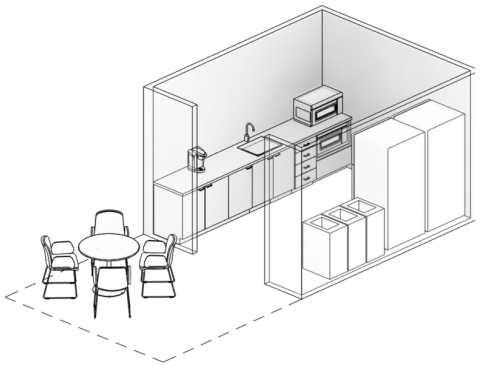


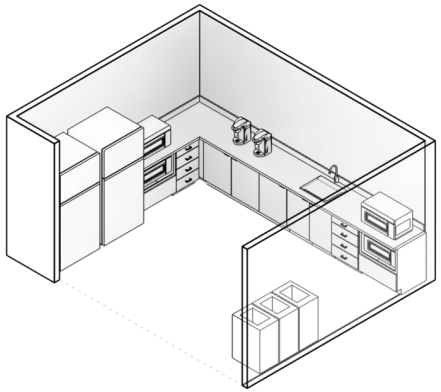
120 SF EXAMPLE + OPEN COLLABORATION



180 SF EXAMPLE



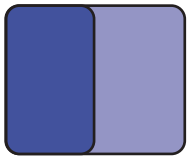




Support Spaces

COPY / PRINT, STORAGE

Copy/Print stations and **Storage** areas are support spaces located within an office suite. These spaces can be enclosed rooms or more flexible furniture options incorporated along circulation paths or within open office areas. The planning unit for these spaces is to be considered as a module and can be adjusted based on an individual unit's specific needs.



60 sf 6x10 **120 sf** 12x10

Copy / Print
Storage

Furniture options for copy/print stations and storage maximize flexibility, as furniture can be more easily reconfigured than hard walled spaces.

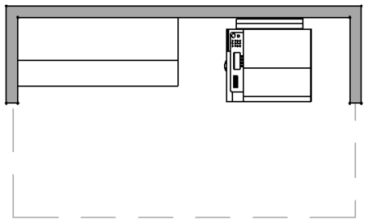
More tips to maximize office space budget on page 2

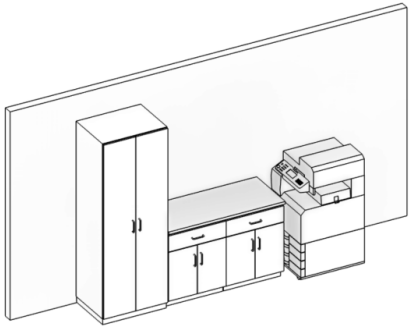
Architectural Guidelines	Technology / Mangement Guidelines
Locate copy/print stations to be easily accessible to employees, with acoustic separation from workpoints and other quiet spaces	Items not requiring regular access shall be stored at the Central Receiving Warehouse or at an off-campus location
Consolidate storage areas where possible to maximize efficiency	Files and/or records shall be digitized for those types of information not prohibited by regulation or law
Incorporate storage for office supplies into copy/print stations	Storage to be reviewed at regular intervals and unnecessary items purged. Consider adopting an annual program to sort, purge, and archive documents
Mail slots, if provided, shall be free-standing furniture elements so they can be easily removed as needs change	Centralized copy/print stations shared by multiple groups allows for efficient use of space and resources, as both operating costs and energy usage are reduced by sharing equipment
Allow adequate space for copiers and printers to ensure flexibility when units are replaced. Coordinate with Wolf Copy to confirm dimensions	
Allocate space for trash and recycling units as provided by NC State Waste Reduction and Recycling, either at the copy/print station or in an adjacent area	
Specify durable materials for counters and cabinets, such as plastic laminate	

Support Spaces

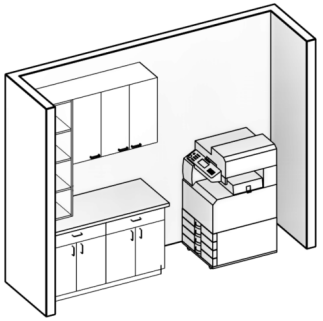
COPY / PRINT

Example diagrams below.





EXAMPLE 1



EXAMPLE 2



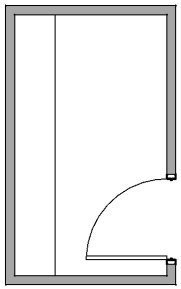
60 sf
6x10

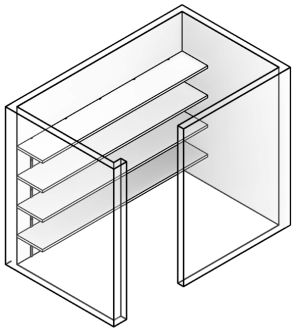
Copy / Print

Support Spaces

STORAGE

Example diagrams below.







60 sf
6x10

Storage



NC State University
Facilities Division
Campus Planning and Strategic Investment